

Major suit raises

This set of practice deals is about very basic bidding using only Major suit bids. The Major suits are Hearts and Spades.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam. The important point is figuring out how many combined points the partnership has.

Keep in mind:

you need 26 points to make game (4♥ 4♠)

you need 33 points to make slam (6♥ 6♠)

open 1♥ or 1♠ with 13-21 points at least five of the suit

respond by raising to 2-level with 6-10 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 3-level with 11-12 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 4-level with 13-16 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 4-level with 8-12 points and at least five of the suit

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 4 ♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥4

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 4 ♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♣K

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 1 ♥
Declarer: South
Lead: ♠K

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 4 ♠
Declarer: West
Lead: ♣5

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 4 ♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♦10

Board: 6
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 3 ♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥10

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 6
♥ A J 10 9
♦ Q 10 9 4
♣ J 10 9 5

♠ A Q 9 7 5 3

♥ Q 7

♦ A K 3

♣ K 2



♠ K 4
♥ 8 6 4 3
♦ J 7 5 2
♣ A 8 4

♠ J 10 8 2

♥ K 5 2

♦ 8 6

♣ Q 7 6 3

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♠

Pass

2 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by North

Lead: ♥ 4

NORTH has 20 points, counting two extra for the fifth and sixth ♠s. Naturally she opens 1 ♠.

SOUTH has a poor hand, but with 7 points he must respond. He has four of partner's ♠s so he responds 2 ♠.

NORTH KNOWS that $6 + 20 = 26$, so she GOES to 4 ♠.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ J 8
♥ K Q 5 4
♦ 9 7 5 3
♣ 10 6 4

♠ K 10 9 3 2

♥ 10 9

♦ A 10 4

♣ 9 7 2



♠ A 7 4
♥ A J 8 7 2
♦ K Q J
♣ A 3

♠ Q 6 5

♥ 6 3

♦ 8 6 2

♣ K Q J 8 5

EAST has 20 points, but with a 5-card Major opens 1♥ rather than 2NT.

WEST barely has enough points for a response, but she does have four ♥s. So she responds 2♥.

EAST adds WEST's 6 to his 20 and bids the game, 4♥.

*West**North**East**South*

2♥

Pass

4♥

Pass

All Pass

4♥ by East

Lead: ♣K

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K Q 9 7
♥ A 5
♦ 7 2
♣ Q 10 9 6 3

♠ J 8 6 3

♥ 6 3

♦ J 8 4 3

♣ 8 7 5



♠ 10 5 4 2
♥ J 10
♦ A 10 9 6 5
♣ A J

♠ A

♥ K Q 9 8 7 4 2

♦ K Q

♣ K 4 2

SOUTH has 20 points because she gets to add one point each for her fifth, sixth and seventh ♥s. So she opens 1♥.

NORTH, with just 2 points, would have passed almost anything SOUTH bid. Certainly he passes the 1♥ bid.

*West**North**East**South*

1♥

All Pass

1♥ by South

Lead: ♠K

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K Q 10 6 5

♥ K Q 2

♦ K 8 7

♣ 8 3

♠ A 7

♥ A J 10 5

♦ 10 3 2

♣ Q 9 5 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 8 4 2

♥ 9 7 6

♦ Q J

♣ A K 7 2

♠ 9 3

♥ 8 4 3

♦ A 9 6 5 4

♣ J 10 6

West

1 ♠

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by West

Lead: ♣5

North

Pass

East

3 ♠

South

Pass

WEST has 14 points so he opens one of his 5-card Major suit, 1 ♠.

EAST has some good ♣s, but with four of partner's Major she doesn't bother bidding anything else. Since she has 11 points she jumps to 3 ♠, a Limit Raise.

WEST is very close to passing. He now gets to add a point for his doubleton ♣ which takes him up to 15 points. So he has enough to bid 4 ♠.

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A 4
♥ 10 7 6 5
♦ 8 4 3 2
♣ Q 10 3

♠ K J 8 7 2

♥ A 9 8

♦ K Q J

♣ 6 5



♠ Q 6

♥ Q 4 3

♦ 10 9 7 6

♣ A J 9 8

♠ 10 9 5 3

♥ K J 2

♦ A 5

♣ K 7 4 2

NORTH has a normal opening bid of 1♠.

SOUTH has a Limit Raise in ♠s, 11 points and 4 ♠s. He responds 3♠

NORTH figures that 15 points is enough for game with partner showing 11/12. She bids 4♠.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	1♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			
4♠ by North			
Lead: ♦ 10			

Board 6

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 5 4 3
 ♥ K 5 3
 ♦ 10 6 5
 ♣ Q J 8 5

♠ K Q 10 9 8

♥ J

♦ 9 7 2

♣ K 9 7 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 6

♥ A Q 8 7 6 4 2

♦ A 3

♣ 4 2

♠ J 7 2

♥ 10 9

♦ K Q J 8 4

♣ A 10 3

West

Pass

2♥

All Pass

3♥ by East

Lead: ♥10

North

Pass

Pass

East

1♥

3♥

South

Pass

WEST has 6 points and wouldn't dream of opening.

EAST has 17 points, counting three extra length points, so she opens 1♥.

WEST does have enough to raise to 2♥.

EAST makes one more try, inviting with a 3♥ bid but WEST just passes.